FIRM HEAD

GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT & SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

"When terrace football dies, the ultra spirit finds a new green."

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

FIRM HEAD is a comedic 1980s-set tactical satire and sports-adventure game. Following the total government ban and disbandment of UK football firms, players take control of Tony Notion—a legendary, ridiculously short terrace leader—as he attempts to channel his aggressive fanatical energy into the pristine world of British gentle leisure and amateur sports.

Setting & Era

1980s South Yorkshire, England. Gritty, rain-slicked industrial landscapes contrasting against immaculate manicured lawns and genteel village halls.

Genre

Comedy Satire / Tactical Mini-game RPG. Combines rhythm mechanics, physics-based lawn sports, and dialogue-driven intimidation.

Protagonist

Tony Notion ("Toe-Nee, No-Shin"). Short stature, absurdly short legs, retro tracksuit, permanent Henderson's Relish holster.

Core Theme

A satirical critique of British class culture, bureaucracy, and the unyielding absurdity of fanatic loyalty applied to low-stakes hobbies.

2. CHARACTER PROFILE: TONY NOTION

Background: Former leader of the *Steel City Anarchy* (supporting Sheffield Steel City FC). A satirical parody of cinematic hooligan leaders, possessing intense theatrical bravado, a thick Sheffield accent, and zero physical height.

Niche Sheffield Traits: Deep, fanatical devotion to Henderson's Relish ("Hendos") which he splashes on all post-match snacks; measures urban & sports terrain using local alleyways ("jennels"); treats tea-biscuit etiquette like military tactics.

3. FIVE-ACT NARRATIVE STRUCTURE

The campaign tracks Tony's descent into polite leisure as he gradually accumulates strange habits from each discipline, escalating from local parks to national high-society scandals.

> *"He doesn't see lawn bowling, flower arranging, or croquet. He sees 22 men, sacred turf, and a front line waiting to be broken."*

Act I: Disbanded & Displacement

The firm is banned. Tony wanders Sheffield jennels before stumbling upon a Crown Green Bowling match and experiencing his first tactical epiphany.

Act II: The Recruitment Drive

Tony converts retirees and flower arrangers into the *Gentlemen's Ultra Movement (GUM)*, equipping them with custom knitted stone-style scarves.

Act III: The Tour of Chaos

Taking GUM on the road across Yorkshire, terrorizing snooker halls, bird hides, and synchronized swimming pools with terrace tactics.

Act IV: Bureaucracy & Showdown

Parish councils wage slow paperwork war. Tony clashes with a rival firm leader on the regional Dressage & Ballroom circuits.

4. THE NARRATIVE EPIPHANY LOOP

Every new sport follows a three-stage narrative sequence that unlocks Tony's tactical abilities:

PHASE	EXPOSITION	GAMEPLAY OUTCOME
1. The Monologue	An earnest enthusiast explains complex, boring rules.	Audio muffles into Charlie Brown style white noise.
2. The Epiphany	Tony's brain rewires polite etiquette into hooligan warfare.	Camera zooms on Tony's unblinking eyes with 80s synth pad.
3. The Skill Unlock	Tony snaps back holding a distorted version of the sport.	Unlocks core mini-game ability (e.g., *The Wedge-Shove*).

5. CORE SYSTEMS: MAD-LIBS TERRACE CHANTS

During matches, Tony maintains team morale and intimidates opponents using the dynamic **Chant Builder** UI, stylized like a 1980s newsprint fanzine.

Chant Construction System

Players are presented with classic terrace rhythm templates containing missing syntax slots. Word tiles are harvested from local town chatter and sport rulebooks:

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"YOU'RE GOING HOME IN A [CROQUET BASKET]!"
"WE'LL FIGHT YOU ON THE [SACRED TURF]!"
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- **Intimidation Rating:** Shock value reduces opponent aiming precision.
- **Cohesion Rating:** Rhyme rhythm charges Tony's *Ultra Meter* for special moves.

6. SATIRE OF BUREAUCRACY & BANNING ORDERS

In true 1980s fashion, local councils and sports governing bodies move at an agonizingly slow, paperwork-heavy pace, creating the core game progression loop.

ADMINISTRATIVE PHASE	GAMEPLAY MECHANICS & LOOPHOLE EXPLOITATION
Infraction	Tony completely ruins a regional sports event (e.g., launching smoke bombs at bowls).
Tribunal Delay	The *Croquet Standards Board* takes 6 to 8 weeks to draw up formal tribunal paperwork.
Loophole Window	During the administrative review, Tony remains legally free to enter regional finals.
Banning Order	Official stamped PDF/Document pop-up detailing absurd grounds for expulsion.

7. THE 20 SPORTS & ACCUMULATED ULTRA QUIRKS (1–10)

As Tony progresses through his sports campaign, he permanently acquires traits, gear, and behavioral quirks that stack onto his character in subsequent levels.

#	SPORT / HOBBY	ACQUIRED ULTRA QUIRK / BEHAVIOR	STAT / GAMEPLAY EFFECT
1	Crown Green Bowling	Pacing-out jennels & alleyways like pitch dimensions.	+10% Movement Spatial Awareness
2	Badminton	Smashing shuttlecocks with penalty-kick force while chanting.	Unlocks *Racket Power Shot*
3	Croquet	Carrying mallet like a firm walking stick; lawn invasions.	Melee Intimidation Boost
4	Darts (Pub League)	Smuggling indoor pyrotechnics & sparklers to the oche.	Screen Blinding Smoke Effect
5	Archery	Terrace face-paint behind hay bales; roars on release.	+15% Precision Targeting
6	Snooker	Slams cue like corner flag; kicks table legs on miss.	Rage Meter Accelerator
7	Table Tennis	Erratic short-leg footwork; headbutts partition walls.	Fast Reflex Parry
8	Bird Watching	Militarized hides; shouts "OFFSHORE FIRM!" at lapwings.	Unlocks Scouting Binoculars
9	Fly Fishing	Full waterproof away-day gear; roars at trout.	Environmental Hazard Immunity
10	Curling	Aggressive ice sweeping while screaming "AWAY YOU!"	Surface Momentum Control

8. THE 20 SPORTS & ACCUMULATED ULTRA QUIRKS (11–20)

#	SPORT / HOBBY	ACQUIRED ULTRA QUIRK / BEHAVIOR	STAT / GAMEPLAY EFFECT
11	Bocce / Petanque	Deploys homemade banger-and-cardboard smoke bombs.	Area-of-Effect Disruption
12	Flower Arranging	Evaluates bouquet structural integrity like a back line.	Defensive Formation Buff
13	Synchronized Swim	Attempts underwater ultra wedge formations in pools.	Stamina Drain Resistance
14	Pigeon Racing	Trains homing birds as elite tactical scouting operatives.	Aerial Reconnaissance Ability
15	Crochet Circle	Knits aggressive scarves with crude slogans while glaring.	Unlocks Custom Firm Gear
16	Pub Quiz Night	Treats laminated quiz sheets like matchday programmes.	Knowledge Intimidation Bonus
17	Amateur Operatics	Hijacks choir harmonies into booming terrace chants.	Acoustic Stun Ability
18	Ballroom Dancing	Converts the Waltz into a rigid, hostile wedge-shove.	Crowd Pushing Force
19	Footgolf	Shoulder-charges golfers on putting green holding Hendos.	Knockdown Physicality
20	Dressage	Barks terrace commands to prize horses; legs dangling.	Ultimate Cavalry Mastery

9. VISUAL & AUDIO DIRECTION

Aesthetics

Stylized 1980s newsprint UI, retro tracksuits, stonewash denim, juxtaposed against immaculate green tea-rooms and lawns.

Sound Design

Dynamic 80s synth-pop soundtrack blending into echoing terrace chants, set to a rich, authentic Sheffield voice cast.